

Agile Team Charter for SE4450

Team Identity

Team name and logo: *Agile Alligators*



AGILE ALLIGATORS

Project title: *news for u ^-^*

Project mission: *Many people struggle to engage with new domains because news and commentary often assume prior knowledge and rely on industry jargon. This project aims to build an AI-powered news platform that aggregates articles, simplifies them based on user familiarity, provides contextual definitions, ensures accessibility, and recommends relevant follow-up content to support inclusive and informed learning.*

Objective: *To build a customizable, AI-powered news platform that aggregates news from multiple sources and adapts explanations to a reader's level of familiarity. The system will simplify articles, provide contextual definitions (through popups or expandable explanations), and recommend relevant follow-up content based on user preferences and feedback.*

Potential Scope: *Prototype a working web platform that:*

- *Scrapes and aggregates articles.*
- *Uses an LLM to rewrite/simplify based on user-selected knowledge level.*
- *Provides contextual popups for explanations.*
- *Includes a feedback mechanism to improve personalization*
- *Screen reader accessibility*
- *Implements a simple recommendation system powered by ML*

Roles and responsibilities

- **Instructor (Course Lead):** *Abdelkader Ouda, aouda@uwo.ca*— oversight, grading rubric alignment, milestone governance, cross-team arbitration; sponsor role if no external partner.
- **Faculty Advisor (Team Coach):** *Yimin Yang, yimin.yang@uwo.ca*— technical mentorship, scope realism, regular check-ins, co-signs key deliverables per program policy.
- **Instructor as Sponsor:** *Abdelkader Ouda, aouda@uwo.ca*— problem context, success criteria, timely feedback, data/assets, milestone reviews.
- **Product Owner (student):** *Vivek Jariwala, vjariwal@uwo.ca*— orders backlog, writes acceptance criteria, schedules review, integrates feedback.
- **Scrum Master/Facilitator (student):** *Kaura Sankaran, ksankar5@uwo.ca* — facilitates ceremonies, removes impediments, tracks improvement actions.
- **Developers/Engineers (students):**
 - *Vivek Jariwala - vjariwal@uwo.ca*
 - *Kaura Sankaran - ksankar5@uwo.ca*
 - *Sharaf Syed - ssyed243@uwo.ca*
 - *Scarlet Wu swu664@uwo.ca*— cross functional delivery (UI/API/data/QA/UX), own quality and DoD.
- **Stakeholders/SMEs (if any):** *N/A* — feedback cadences, decisions required.

A draft for a RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed) chart, that will be updated per project phases/sprints. [Provide a link to the repo.](#)

Activity/Person	Kaura	Scarlet	Sharaf	Vivek
API/Scraping Testing	C	C	R/A	C
Building Machine Learning Model	I	C	C	R/A
Backend Connectivity	C	I	R/A	C
Database Testing	R/A	R/A	I	I
User Acceptance Testing	C	R/A	I	I
UI/Interface Modelling	R/A	C	I	I

Working agreements

1. **Collaboration:**
 - *Pull Requests (PRs) reviewed within 48 hours.*
 - *Pair on complex PRs (>200 LOC or high impact).*
 - *Task allocation on Jira*
 - *General project updates documented in a shared Microsoft Word document in Microsoft Teams.*
2. **Core hours:** *Monday and Wednesday evenings are reserved for focused work.*
3. **Meeting-free blocks:** *Monday, Wednesday, Friday, and Sunday, 6–10 PM EST.*
4. **Weekly scrum times (at least 3x per week):** *Tuesday, Thursday 5PM, Saturday 12PM EST*
5. **Availability:** *Publish weekly availability in Lettucemeet or other calendar organizer tool sent towards the end of the previous week.*
6. **Interrupt protocol:** *Use group discord channel to notify group immediately for imminent blockers, otherwise, refer to Collaboration.*
7. **Retro actions:** *Commit to 1–2 concrete improvements per sprint with owners/dates; verify completion in next retro.*
8. **Task assignment:** *Tasks will be assigned and ownership will be taken through task items on Jira. (When the Jira page is up we will link it with our GitHub)*

Decision rules

- **Routine (two-way door):** *Implementer decides and documents decision in PR notes or issue comments.*
- **Significant design/scope (one-way door):**
 - *Architecture Decision Record (ADR) required.*
 - *Decision by consent among Product Owner, Tech Lead, and Faculty Advisor*
 - *Team members reach majority on decision*
- **Conflict escalation path:** *Peer mediation → Faculty Advisor → Instructor (final arbiter).*
- **Timebox expiry default:**
 - *Move forward with the most reversible option, document the decision, and revisit only if necessary.*
 - *For consequential design decisions, record them as an ADR. If no agreement is reached, the team votes and majority rules.*

Communication norms

- **System of record for work/decisions:** *GitHub repo (issues, code, decisions). Teams used for off-repo documents. Jira for splitting individual tasks.*
- **Quick async:** *Discord group chat for rapid coordination and clarifications. Summarize decisions back to repo or Teams.*
- **Formal notices/deliverables:**
 - *Submitted via OWL Brightspace - Instructor, Advisor.*
- **Cadences:**
 - *Stand-ups: Tuesday and Thursday @ 5:00 PM EST, Saturday @ 12:00 PM EST (15–20 min)*
 - *Weekly backlog refinement.*
 - *Biweekly sprint planning, review, and retrospective.*
 - *Advisor check-in: Weekly or biweekly, based on availability.*

Definition of Done (DoD)

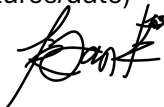
An item is Done when:

- *Code is merged into main after PR is review by another developer and all automated checks/tests pass.*
- *Documentation is updated (README, API docs, changelog, user notes if applicable).*
- *Feature is demonstrable in Sprint Review and part of the potentially shippable increment.*

Signatures and acknowledgments

All signatures here acknowledge and agree to the terms set out in this team charter.

Students (names/signatures/date)

- Kaura Sankaran  **Date:** 9/17/2025
- Vivek Jariwala  **Date:** 9/17/2025
- Scarlett Wu  **Date:** 9/17/2025
- Sharaf Syed  **Date:** 9/17/2025

Product Owner, Vivek Jariwala  **Date:** 9/17/2025

Scrum Master/Facilitator, Kaura Sankaran  **Date:** 9/17/2025

Faculty Advisor, Yimin Yang  **Date:** 9/18/2025

Instructor as Sponsor, Abdelkader Ouda **Date:**

Instructor, Abdelkader Ouda **Date:**

Addendum (9/18/2025):

The team acknowledges the addition of Co-Faculty Advisor: Dr. Elvis Chen, P. Eng.